VASAVA VS VASAVA





Six-term Bharuch MP and BJP veteran **Mansukh Vasava's** envy over the growing clout of a younger Vasava—AAP's Chhota Udepur MLA **Chaitar Vasava**—has finally spilled into the open. At a recent presser, a livid Mansukh accused party colleague and Nandod MLA Darshna Deshmukh of dangling "lollipops" to lure Chaitar into the BJP, a move, he claimed, was aimed at undercutting him on his own turf. Darshana has brushed off the charge, and Chaitar has mocked "the drama", but the spat has laid bare the chaos within the Gujarat BJP's tribal unit.

The Lion in Winter



Four years after falling vacant in February 2021, J&K is set to fill its four Rajya Sabha seats on October 24. A notable absence will be National Conference president **Farooq Abdullah**, 88, whose waning health pushed him to step down. The ruling NC nominated three members, leaving one 'unsafe' seat to ally Congress (which declined the offer). Abdullah Sr, who first entered Parliament in 1980, is still a voice that counts and a cushion for son and J&K CM Omar in his run-ins with New Delhi.

ROYAL FIGHT



Gonda BJP MP and Union minister **Kirti Vardhan Singh** wears many hats. But now the titular raja of Uttar Pradesh's Mankapur also seems keen on managing the Awadh region's internal affairs. Earlier this month, he was elected president of the Anjuman-e-Hind-e-Awadh—an association of former Awadhi aristocrats including 322 taluqdars and erstwhile royal families—succeeding his father Anand Singh, who led it for 28 years. In a closely watched contest held in Lucknow, Kirti defeated Jayendra Pratap Singh of the Balrampur royal family by 130 votes. Guess it's time to take out the silverware for the coronation party.

Kaushik Deka with Suhani Singh, Avaneesh Misra, Jumana Shah, Kaleem Geelani and Rahul Noronha

HEALTH WATCH

By **Sonali Acharjee**

GUT FEELING
CSIR BETS ON MICROBES TO HEAL CHRONIC ILLS

What if your gut could hold the key to curing chronic disease? India's premier science body, the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR), certainly thinks so. In a landmark project, CSIR scientists are mapping how trillions of microbes living inside us could be used to diagnose and even treat disorders like IBD, acne, liver disease and even Parkinson's—and without a single invasive test.



The project—led by CSIR-IMTECH, Chandigarh—aims to decode the microbial 'signatures' that mark different diseases. Using next-gen sequencing and AI, researchers plan to turn something as simple as a stool sample into a diagnostic goldmine. It's a bold step towards what could be India's own gut-driven revolution in precision medicine.

"Western microbiome data can't explain Indian health patterns; our food, climate and genes are just too different," says Dr Rashmi Kumar, who heads the IMTECH team. That's why CSIR is building a vast Indian microbiome database, mapping how diet, pollution and even geography shape gut health. If it works, the outcome could be transformative: personalised probiotics, diet-based therapies, and fewer painful tests. For once, "trust your gut" might be more than a metaphor—it could be the future of Indian healthcare.